

Social Return on Investment (SROI)

What this tool produces · *An SROI report detailing the monetized social impacts, adjusted for deadweight and displacement, and culminating in a clear benefit-to-investment ratio.*

G4 · Proof of Sustainability

G1 · Proof of Impact

Dimensions

Social / User

Economic

Environmental

Preparing the workshop · *Social Return on Investment (SROI)*

G4 · Proof of Sustainability

Why this tool matters

Providing an indisputable language for care and resilience, forcing traditional accounting to register human joy, safety, and community attachment as the ultimate civic assets.

Evidence we produce

An SROI report detailing the monetized social impacts, adjusted for deadweight and displacement, and culminating in a clear benefit-to-investment ratio.

Duration & Material

Duration · 8 to 12 weeks

Material · Financial proxy databases (e.g., HACT), stakeholder engagement surveys, impact calculation frameworks

Reference case

For the Connswater Community Greenway in Belfast, an SROI analysis used real-world data to monetize elements like flood alleviation, health, and productivity. The evaluation proved that for every £1 invested in the greenway, the local economy gained up to £1.59, justifying the long-term public expenditure. In an Italian urban green space project, researchers monetized the reduction of loneliness and creation of social connections, finding that every euro invested in these na...

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

SROI · social return on investment

Duration
8 to 12 weeks

$$\text{SROI} = \Sigma \text{Social value generated} / \Sigma \text{Investment costs}$$

Stakeholders

who is impacted · how

Outcomes

what changes for them

Valuation

monetize using proxies

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.